

Document 3: Examination & Grading Manual

Institution: Hyderabad Institute of Technology (HIT)

Document Version: 2026.1

Effective Academic Year: 2026-2027

1. Overview of the Institutional Evaluation Architecture

The academic assessment strategy at Hyderabad Institute of Technology operates on a dual-evaluation framework designed to measure both continuous learning and summative comprehension. As an autonomous institution, HIT strictly enforces a forty-to-sixty evaluation ratio, splitting the total marks for any theoretical subject between internal assessments and external final exams.

The Office of the Controller of Examinations (COE) holds absolute authority over scheduling, question paper generation, script evaluation, and result publication. Every theory course carries a total weight of one hundred marks. Out of these, forty marks are allocated to Continuous Internal Evaluation, which is monitored by the subject teacher throughout the semester. The remaining sixty marks are dedicated to the Semester End Examination, a comprehensive final test conducted under strict university surveillance.

To pass any given theory subject, a student is mandated to clear two separate mathematical thresholds simultaneously. First, the student must score an absolute minimum of twenty-one marks out of the sixty available in the Semester End Examination. Second, the combination of their internal marks and their final exam marks must equal at least forty out of one hundred. Failing to meet either of these specific numerical conditions will result in an automatic failing grade for that subject.

2. Continuous Internal Evaluation (CIE) Mechanics

The forty marks dedicated to internal continuous evaluation are not awarded in a single test. Instead, they are fragmented into multiple different academic tasks spread across the sixteen weeks of the semester to ensure students maintain consistent study habits.

The internal assessment score comprises three distinct testing formats. The highest weightage is given to the Mid-Term Examinations. The academic calendar includes two mid-term tests per semester. Each mid-term test is graded out of twenty-five marks. The primary mid-term occurs during the eighth week, covering the first half of the syllabus, while the secondary mid-term occurs in the fifteenth week, covering the latter half. To calculate the final mid-term contribution, the university takes eighty percent of the higher-scoring test and twenty percent of the lower-scoring test, blending them to form a final score out of twenty-five.

Furthermore, ten marks are strictly allocated to subjective assignments. Faculty members assign two major writing tasks or minor research projects per semester. Each assignment carries a maximum of five marks. These must be submitted physically or uploaded to the university portal before the respective mid-term week begins. Late submissions instantly trigger a fifty percent mark deduction penalty.

Finally, the remaining five marks of the internal evaluation are reserved for Surprise Slip Tests or active classroom participation. Teachers are empowered to conduct unannounced quizzes consisting of multiple-choice questions or short-answer problems during random lecture hours. The average of the best two slip tests is finalized and added to the student's internal record.

3. Laboratory Evaluation and Practical Course Protocols

Practical subjects follow a completely different grading philosophy compared to theoretical classes. Because engineering relies heavily on hands-on software coding, hardware manipulation, and physical experimentation, the entire evaluation is strictly observed inside the university laboratories.

Out of the one hundred marks designated for a laboratory course, a massive fifty marks are controlled by the internal faculty member observing the student's day-to-day performance. This daily evaluation looks at three factors. First, the student's ability to execute the experiment successfully is graded out of twenty marks. Second, the timely submission and neatness of their handwritten laboratory record book carries another twenty marks. The final ten marks are awarded based on a short, on-the-spot oral questioning session regarding that specific day's experiment.

The remaining fifty marks are determined during the External Practical Examination held at the end of the semester. To ensure absolute fairness and prevent bias, the university mandates that this final practical exam be supervised by a two-person panel. One examiner is the regular class teacher, but the second examiner must be a completely unknown faculty member invited from a different engineering college. During this three-hour exam, the student must draw a random experiment chit, perform the setup without any assistance, record the output data, and defend their methodology to the external examiner.

4. Semester End Examination (SEE) Code of Conduct

The final written tests are highly secure events governed by strict disciplinary guidelines to prevent academic fraud. These examinations test the entirety of the syllabus over a duration of three full hours.

Entry into the examination hall is heavily restricted. Students are required to download their digitally signed Hall Ticket from the student portal at least three days prior to the first exam. This document, alongside a physical college identification card, serves as the only acceptable proof of identity. The gates of the examination block open precisely thirty minutes before the scheduled start time. Once the starting bell rings, a grace period of exactly fifteen minutes is granted for latecomers. After the fifteen-minute mark has passed, the iron gates are permanently locked, and no student is permitted to enter under any circumstances, including vehicle breakdowns or severe traffic delays.

Inside the hall, the seating arrangement is randomized digitally every single day, meaning a student will never sit in the same desk twice. Students are only allowed to carry transparent water bottles, standard blue or black ballpoint pens, graphite pencils, non-programmable scientific calculators, and standard geometrical drawing instruments. The possession of smartwatches, Bluetooth earpieces, mobile phones, or even blank pieces of rough paper is classified as a severe criminal violation of university policy, leading to immediate confiscation of the answer booklet and removal from the premises.

5. Letter Grading System and Numerical Point Mapping

HIT utilizes a universally recognized ten-point letter grading scale recommended by the national higher education commission. Instead of printing raw percentages on the final degree certificate, the university maps a student's total marks (combining internal and external scores) to specific letter bands.

- **Grade O (Outstanding):** Awarded when a student secures ninety percent or above in total marks. This grade translates to a perfect ten grade points.
- **Grade A+ (Excellent):** Given to those who achieve between eighty percent and eighty-nine percent. It awards nine grade points.
- **Grade A (Very Good):** Assigned for marks ranging from seventy percent to seventy-nine percent, yielding eight grade points.
- **Grade B+ (Good):** Applies to scores between sixty percent and sixty-nine percent, mapping to seven grade points.
- **Grade B (Above Average):** Covers the fifty-five to fifty-nine percent range, providing six grade points.
- **Grade C (Average):** Represents the bare minimum passing bracket, given for marks strictly between fifty and fifty-four percent. It awards exactly five grade points.
- **Grade F (Fail):** Issued when a student scores forty-nine percent or below, or fails to meet the twenty-one mark external threshold. This grants zero grade points and requires a complete re-examination.
- **Grade Ab (Absent):** Logged when a student simply does not show up for the final test. It operates mathematically identical to a Fail grade.

6. Mathematical Formulas for SGPA and CGPA Calculation

To track academic progression, the university calculates two distinct performance metrics: the Semester Grade Point Average (SGPA) and the Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA). These metrics are weighted mathematical averages based on the number of credits assigned to each subject.

The SGPA measures the performance of a student within a single, isolated academic term. It is computed by multiplying the grade points earned in a specific course by the credits allocated to that course, summing those values across all registered subjects, and finally dividing by the total number of credits attempted in that semester.

$$\text{SGPA} = (\text{Sum of (Credits} \times \text{Grade Points) for all courses in the semester}) \div (\text{Total Credits in the semester})$$

The CGPA, conversely, evaluates the entire academic journey from the first day of freshman year up to the most recently completed semester. It uses the exact same weighted methodology, but applies it across all courses taken over multiple semesters.

$$\text{CGPA} = (\text{Sum of (Credits} \times \text{Grade Points) for all completed courses}) \div (\text{Total Credits earned across all completed courses})$$

Students aiming to convert their final graduation CGPA into a standard percentage equivalent for job applications must multiply their final CGPA by ten, as mandated by the institutional academic council.

7. Policies Regarding Absentees and Medical Make-Up Tests

Missing a scheduled examination is treated as a critical academic failure unless the student can provide legally binding proof of an unavoidable emergency.

If a student is absent during an internal Mid-Term examination due to severe hospitalization, an accident, or the death of an immediate family member, they hold the right to petition for a Make-Up Examination. This petition must be drafted, attached to a stamped medical certificate from a government-recognized hospital, and submitted directly to the Head of the Department within three working days of the missed test. Standard fever, minor ailments, or travel delays are summarily rejected. If the Head of the Department validates the proof, a completely new, vastly more difficult question paper is generated, and the student must sit for the make-up test over the weekend.

Crucially, there is absolutely no provision for a make-up test if a student misses a Semester End Examination. Regardless of the severity of the medical emergency, missing the final external exam instantly results in an Absent grade. The student is left with no alternative but to wait a full six months and write the supplementary examination alongside their junior batch, paying the full supplementary penalty fee in the process.

8. Answer Script Re-Evaluation and Challenge Valuation Process

Understanding that human error can occur during the mass grading of thousands of answer booklets, HIT provides a transparent mechanism for students to contest their final grades if they believe an injustice has occurred.

The first step available is the Photocopy Verification Request. Within exactly one week of the results being declared online, a student can pay a non-refundable administrative charge of five hundred rupees to receive a high-resolution scanned copy of their graded answer script. This allows the student to sit down with their subject teacher, review the exact marks awarded for every single question, and check for simple totaling errors or completely unread pages.

If the student and teacher determine that the answers were fundamentally undervalued, the student can proceed to apply for Challenge Valuation. This is a high-stakes process requiring a massive deposit of three thousand rupees. Once paid, the original answer booklet is sealed, anonymized, and sent to a highly experienced senior professor from a completely different university for a fresh, blind evaluation. If the new evaluator increases the score by more than fifteen percent of the total marks, the university officially changes the grade and refunds the entire three thousand rupee deposit back to the student. If the score does not change, or decreases, the university retains the money and the most recent score becomes permanently binding.

9. Malpractice and Disciplinary Penalties

Academic integrity is the cornerstone of the institution, and the examination cell enforces a zero-tolerance approach toward any form of cheating, plagiarism, or coordinated fraud.

If an invigilator catches a student glancing at their neighbor's paper or attempting to communicate through whispers or hand signals, it is classified as Level One Malpractice. The student's answer booklet is confiscated, a bold red line is drawn across their current answers, and they are forced to write the remainder of the exam on a completely new booklet, losing massive amounts of time in the process.

Level Two Malpractice involves the discovery of smuggled written materials, hidden notes in pockets, or formulas written on the skin or clothing. If caught, the student is instantly expelled from the examination hall. The Chief Superintendent is summoned, and the student is booked under an official malpractice case. The immediate punishment is the cancellation of that specific exam, resulting in an automatic zero.

The most severe category, Level Three Malpractice, occurs if a student is caught attempting to use an electronic device, substituting another person to write the exam on their behalf, or physically threatening the invigilation staff. The punishment for this offense is catastrophic. All examinations written by the student during that entire semester are canceled, their registration is suspended, and they are barred from entering the campus for one full academic year. In cases of impersonation, the university also files a First Information Report with the local police department for criminal fraud.